



GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate.

AUG 2017

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August

Good Things Happen
is the newsletter of
Minnehaha United Methodist Church,
published each month.

The deadline for September is

August 18

Contributions may be brought to the
office or emailed to:
office@minnehaha.org
3701 East 50th Street
Minneapolis, MN 55417

About Us:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church is a thriving multi-generational, multicultural Christian community devoted to social justice and personal spiritual growth. The congregation is both mission- and worship-focused. In addition to its worship, education, and social activities, the church supports local mission activities, including a food shelf and a monthly food distribution program. The church also supports a variety of national and international relief, education, and development projects.

A Reconciling Congregation:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church opens our doors to all God's people. We will strive to offer unconditional love and acceptance to all persons, regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. We work to eliminate prejudice and discriminatory practices within ourselves and within our community. -adopted 2006

Our Mission:

We seek, we serve, we celebrate, we carry our Christian faith into our community and the world. We provide a caring gathering place to worship God and to grow spiritually. -reconfirmed 2011

SUNDAY WORSHIP -SUMMER SCHEDULE

9:00 am Worship with organ and choir.

10:30am Outdoor Worship with band and vocals,
weather permitting.

Infant and toddler care available all morning.



Minnehaha Happenings in August

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
		1 9a Fun & Fitness Group 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters	2 10a Staff Meeting 1p Minnehaha circle 5p Methodicals 7p Children's Council	3 9a Food Shelf Board 9a Fun & Fitness Group 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	4 9a Brighter Minds 10a Al-Anon 6:30p NAMI 6:30p NAMI (additional) 6:30p RCA	5 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
6 International Friendship Day Communion 10:30a Worship at the Falls 7p SAA	7 10a Overeaters Anonymous 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1 6:30p Finance	8 9a Fun & Fitness Group 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Church Council	9 5p Methodicals	10 9a Fun & Fitness Group 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 1p Communion @ Nokomis Sq 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	11 9a Brighter Minds 10a Al-Anon 6:30p NAMI 6:30p RCA	12 6a Joy Catering 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
13 International Left-Handers Day 9a Worship with Organ 10:30a Worship with Band 6:30p Togolese Community Church 7p SAA	14 10a Overeaters Anonymous 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1	15 9a Fun & Fitness Group 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters 6:30p Worship Committee	16 5p Methodicals	17 9a Fun & Fitness Group 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	18 Newsletter items due 9a Brighter Minds 10a Al-Anon 6:30p NAMI 6:30p RCA	19 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
20 Backpack Blessing 9a Worship with Organ 10:30a Worship with Band 7p SAA	21 10a Overeaters Anonymous 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1 6:30p Women's Soul Group	22 9a Fun & Fitness Group 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 5:30p Garden Party 6:30p SPR	23 5p Methodicals	24 9a Fun & Fitness Group 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	25 9a Brighter Minds 9a Newsletter Collation 10a Al-Anon 6:30p NAMI 6:30p RCA	26 7a MinneHarvest 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
27 Animal Blessing 9a Worship with Organ 10:30a Worship with Band 6:30p Togolese Community Church 7p SAA	28 10a Overeaters Anonymous 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1	29 9a Fun & Fitness Group 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music	30 5p Methodicals 5:30p Faith Formation Preschool Open House	31 9a Fun & Fitness Group 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Trustees & B+G	Notes:	

Worship in August

We begin the month with worship at the Falls on August 6, and then hear some great stories from the Bible for the rest of August. The last Sunday in the month, August 27, is the Blessing of the Animals. Bring your pet, stuffed animal, or picture of a pet to the 10:30 service outside.

- Just a note – one worship service on Labor Day weekend. 10:00, in the sanctuary.

6th **Worship at the Falls**

Communion. One Service 10:30 am., Minnehaha Falls

13th *Peter Johnson preaches*

Genesis 37:1-4, 12-28

20th **“Wash Your Hands”**

Blessing of backpacks

Matthew 15:10-20

27th **“Blessed Animals”**

Animal blessing (10:30)

Psalms 8

Save the Date

Future special events at Minnehaha UMC:

- Sept. 3 – One worship service at 10:00 inside
- Sept. 3 – Weekly Youth programming begins
- Sept. 10 – One worship service at 10:00 outside
- Sept. 11 – Monday night study begins – we will be reading *Heart of Christianity* by Marcus Borg
- Sept. 14 – Thursday morning study begins – we will be looking at theological elements that are specific to United Methodists
- Sept. 17 – Sunday morning Christian Education begins
- Sept. 17 – First of three Congregational Workshops. 1:00-3:00. A look at the demographics of our neighborhood.
- Oct. 1 – World Communion Sunday with a Caribbean focus
- Oct. 8 – Confirmation Sunday
- Oct. 22 – Second of three Congregational Workshops
- Nov. 4 – Harvest Dinner and Concert by Timbre Junction
- Nov. 5 – All Saints Sunday
- Nov. 11 – Bazaar

Nov. 22 – Thanksgiving Eve Worship Service

RELIEVE EDITORIAL STRESS:

**TURN IN
YOUR ARTICLES
EARLY!**

RE M I N D E R :

**DEADLINE FOR
NEWSLETTER
ARTICLES IS**

August 18

Youth Ministries

MUMC Youth Activities for August and early September:

Aug. 20th - Special summer edition of Youth News:

- Airs during first service at 9am. You won't want to miss it!

Sept. 3rd - Youth Night Kick-off Pizza and planning party:

- Youth in 6th-12th Grade (4:00-5:30pm)
- All Youth will join us for pizza and help us plan the ways we will Seek, Serve, and Celebrate this upcoming year!

Sept. 10th - Rally Sunday: Youth in 6th-12th Grade (10:00am-1:00pm)

- Worship service starts at 10am,
followed by meeting our Sunday school teachers
and youth serving lunch!
- Please join us for a fantastic kick-off to the fall!
- All proceeds of the lunch help support our Youth program.
 - **Parents Night (4-5pm):**
- We are inviting and encouraging all parents of 6th-12th graders to join us this evening to discuss plans for the upcoming year, the best ways to stay in touch with them, and how they can be involved.
 - **Youth Night (4-5:30pm):**
- While parents are meeting together,
youth will be enjoying a game night in the gym.



Minnehaha kids arrive at Koronis Trailblazers Camp



Children's Ministries

Even as store aisles are being overtaken by back-to-school supplies, we're still very much enjoying summertime. As this arrives at your home or inbox, another group of Minnehaha children will be attending camp, the Minnehaha Playgroup continues its good weather tour of area parks, the church garden is growing, and Sunday mornings means time on the playground and with each other.

We had a wonderful week in June of our summer programs at Minnehaha. More than 30 volunteers, countless donations, and incredible energy and creativity went into making a great week for 60 children and youth. Our Vacation Bible School theme was "Hero Central" so we talked all about how God's love and presence in our lives gives us power to help one another - to be heroes for each other and the world! "Do Good! Seek Peace, and Go After It!" Our Music & Drama Camp production was called "When Pigs Fly" and participants worked to put together a production (led by the incomparable Maureen Trepp) that encouraged us all to be persistent and imaginative and kind.

While we heartily enjoy having all this activity at Minnehaha, it's exciting to head out and have other ad-

ventures as well. This year, eleven of our children attended camps at Northern Pines and at Koronis. Both of these camps are part of the camping ministry of the Minnesota Annual Conference, so the children attend camp not only with friends from Minnehaha, but with people from churches all over the state. They tried out boating, woodworking, archery, wilderness survival skills, geocaching and more. They enjoyed learning silly songs, eating camp food, and of course, time in the lake and water balloon fights. We're so grateful that such opportunities are available to us, and if you haven't considered sending your kids to these camps, we encourage you to talk to this year's attendees - they had a marvelous time!

We also have enjoyed the intergenerational movie nights and Becky's movie sermon series, the opportunity for Thursday Playgroup to explore parks, and time to do a little clean-up and updates in the education wing.

And, this time away from the program year, also gets us excited for the year to start again. And, so, it is indeed that time for us to be start planning and preparing for the year to come, and we do so with great excitement - it's wonderful to work with so many

amazing children and volunteers and the calendar is starting to fill with fun activities and programs for people of all ages. **Rally Sunday, on September 10th, will kick off the year.** We'll worship at just one service - 10am in the sideyard - and lunch and activities will follow!

Enjoy the rest of your summer!

Jenia Strom
*Director of
Children &
Family Ministries*

[Sunday School]

It would be great if you could take a moment to register your child(ren) for the 2017-2018 Sunday School year, as it will help us in these preparations for our year. The link is available on the church website, www.minnehaha.org.



Minnehaha Playgroup

For Children 5 and Under & their Caregivers

Thursdays, from 9-11am

Stop in to play, talk, explore, support, and learn together. Feel free to bring snacks (no peanuts, please) if your child will need them. No RSVP necessary. All are welcome.

hosted by

Minnehaha United Methodist Church

When weather permits, we gather at local parks for playgroup. Otherwise, we meet at Minnehaha UMC, in the Childcare Room. If you'd like to join us on any given week, and want to know where to find us: join the "Minnehaha Playgroup" Facebook Page for weekly updates.

Highlights from the June 13 Church Council Meeting

Ed. Note: Church Council did not meet in July.



TREASURER'S REPORT: We are going into the summer (a traditionally slow period of giving) in a strong financial position. We have paid all bills, mortgage payments, apportionment payments and inter-fund loan payments through May 31, 2017. Thank you! (Dennis Feller, Treasurer)

INFORMATION ABOUT SOLAR PROJECT: If you missed the presentation by the Solar Committee, you can find their report on the church website (www.minnehaha.org). There's a small article on the home page; click the text to download the report. (Kim Kanuit, Trustees)

PLAYGROUND IS REFURBISHED: The playground on the south side of the church has been refurbished. Old chips were removed, and six inches of gravel and 12 inches of playground-safe mulch were put down. A new 8-foot by 8-foot sandbox is being put in, too. (Gene Thompson, Building & Grounds)

NEXT MEETING IS AUGUST 8: There will be no Church Council meeting in July. The next meeting will be August 8 at 6:30 p.m. Everyone in the church is invited to attend. Complete minutes of the meeting are available on request. (Dean Ammerman, Church Council)

Minnehaha UMC Rally Day: Sunday, 10th September

**37th AVENUE WILL BE CLOSED
between 50th Street & 51st Street
from 10:00am to 1pm**

Join with members of the Minnehaha United Methodist Church community as we celebrate the beginning of a new program year.

One Worship Service Outside at 10am

Followed by:

- Meeting & Greeting Sunday School Teachers
- A bike parade and lawn games
- All-Church Lunch

Minnehaha United Methodist Church. We Seek. We Serve. We Celebrate.
3701 E. 50th Street, Minneapolis, MN 55417/612.721.6231/www.minnehaha.org

Monthly Communion at Nokomis Sq.

On the second Thursday of the month at 1:00 p.m., there is a brief communion service at Nokomis Square preceded by a discussion of the chapter we are reading for the week in *We Make The Road By Walking*. Anyone is welcome to come. In August we will be gathering on August 10, and John Darlington will be leading it this month.

Sneak Preview of Fall Adult Classes

This fall, there will be two adult classes offered during the week.

Marcus Borg's *Heart of Christianity* – Monday evenings,

6:30-8:00 Sept. 11 – Nov. 20

Borg is a very readable theologian, and his books (like *Meeting Jesus Again for the First Time*, *Experiencing the Bible Again for the First Time*) are widely read by progressive Christians trying to make sense of their faith.

You will need his book for this class, and we will be discussing the first chapter on September 11, so please let Becky know if you are planning on coming. You can order the book yourself, or ask Becky to place an order for you. If you want Becky to order the book, please let her know by August 27.

What Do United Methodists Believe? – Thursday mornings,

10-11:30 Sept. 14 – Oct. 19

No book or pre-reading is necessary for this class. Just show up and find out what we believe about things like heaven, hell, grace, baptism, and the like.

Blessing of Bags and Backpacks

We will be blessing bags and backpacks at our worship service on August 20. We are collecting back-to-school items for our MinneHarvest clients (see article elsewhere), and we want to give those backpacks a blessing in addition to any backpacks and bags of your own at the same time, so bring your back-to-school backpacks, your messenger bags, your purse, whatever you use to carry stuff, and we'll make sure it gets blessed!

Superheroes on the move, VBS



The Paint-A-Thon needs you!!

August 5th & 6th!

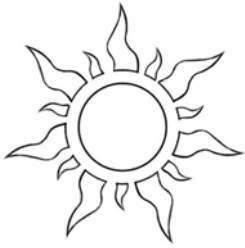
Come join your fellow MUMC members in painting the exterior of a senior citizen's home in the South Mpls area so that she can continue living with dignity and independence in her own home. Lunch and equipment will be provided however all step ladders and stepstools are welcomed. It's a single story house.

When: Saturday-Sunday August 5-6th
either, part or both days. Starting at 9am.

Where: 2020 W. 54th St. Minneapolis
Park on S. Newton Ave (north of 54th St.)
as 54th St is under construction.

Contact: Dave Kocken

dkocken@comcast.net or 612-432-0970 to sign-up.



Training for Everyone

Everyone is essential to the life of a church. You might chair a committee, or be on a committee. Maybe you help teach Sunday School. Or you volunteer for various events. You pick up garbage you see on the floor and put it in the trash. You sing hymns in worship, have conversations with friends new and old. This training is for you! There will be three sessions over the course of the fall:

- Sunday, Sept. 17, 1:00-3:00 –
We'll look at the demographics of our neighborhood and our church.
- Sunday, Oct. 22, 1:00-3:00 –
We say "All Are Welcome!" but how do we actually do that?
- Sunday, Nov. 19, 1:00-3:00 – How to be a true neighbor in our community.

Animal Blessing

Animals play an important role in many of our lives. If you have a special pet, we invite you to bring it to our annual animal blessing service on Sunday, August 27 at the 10:30 service (outside). We'll gather inside if it is raining, but either way, there will be a time in the worship service to have your pet blessed. Whether you have a horse or a hamster, bring them to church. Just make sure it's in a crate or container or on leash of some kind. If you don't have a pet, but wish you did, come anyway, and bring a stuffed animal if you'd like. If your pet doesn't like crowds, other animals, or can't really get out, bring a picture and we'll bless that. You may also wish to recognize the death of a pet in this way. And, invite your friends to bring their pets as well; we welcome everyone.



What: Faith Formation Preschool Open House

When: Wednesday, 30th August; 5:30-7pm

Where: Preschool Room (rm. 202) at Minnehaha

Who: All Families with Preschool Age (3 & 4 year olds) Children for the 2017-2018 Program Year

What: A chance to visit the Sunday School space and to learn about our Faith Formation programs.

At Minnehaha, we strive to help children develop curiosity about their faith, and to give them opportunities to seek, serve, and celebrate God's love in an intergenerational and inclusive setting.

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3701 E. 50th Street, Minneapolis 55417
www.minnehaha.org, 612.721.6231

Questions? Contact Jenia Strom, Director of Children & Family Ministries at education@minnehaha.org

School Supply Drive

It is that time of year again when the ads are coming out for school supplies. Even though it seems like the school year was just finished. Over the last few years the people of Minnehaha have had a great impact on the children of those families who attend the MinneHarvest by providing backpacks filled with school supplies to the children as they return to school in the fall. last year we helped 175 children. Good things do truly happen here. And this year well that is up to all of us

There are three ways to help with this mission

- Buy school supplies and bring them to church
- Designate an offering for school supplies in the Sunday offering
- Donate cash to be used for school supplies

Backpacks will be handed out at the Aug 26th MinneHarvest.

Potluck Supper

Our last potluck of the summer season will be on Tuesday, August 22. Bring a dish to share and something to put on the grill, take a stroll around the garden to see what's growing (pull a couple weeds . . .), play on the playground, and mingle with other Minnehaha folk from 5:30 – 7:00.

Small superheroes strategize with Flame during VBS



AUGUST TRIVIA QUIZ

1. Which animal is associated with summer?
 - a. Tiger
 - b. Pig
 - c. Goat
 - d. Ox
2. Which country singer was born on the 21st of August 1938?
 - a. Travis Tritt
 - b. Garth Brooks
 - c. Kenny Rogers
 - d. Conway Twitty
3. What or who was the month of August named after?
 - a. A British King
 - b. A roman Emperor
 - c. The First Pope
 - d. An Ancient Battle
4. What is the birth flower for August?
 - a. Marigold
 - b. Gladiola
 - c. Violet
 - d. Pansy
5. What is the gemstone for August?
 - a. Sapphire
 - b. Peridot
 - c. Opal
 - d. Garnet
6. Which Alamo fighter was born on the 17th of August, 1786?
 - a. David Bowie
 - b. Davy Crockett
 - c. Sam Houston
 - d. William Travis
7. If you were born in August what Zodiac sign would be associated with your birth?
 - a. Aries
 - b. Leo
 - c. Pieces
 - d. Aquarius
8. What food are you supposed to eat on the 30th of August?
 - a. Toasted marshmallows
 - b. Pepper squash
 - c. Peanuts
 - d. Apples

Eid al-Adha

As many of you know, the celebration at the end of the Islamic observance of Ramadan is called Eid.

There are actually two Eids in the Muslim calendar, and Eid al-Adha is the larger of the celebrations. Eid al-Adha, or the Feast of the Sacrifice, commemorates a story that Judaism, Christianity, and Islam have in common. In our Bibles, you'll find the story in Genesis 22. Abraham is asked to sacrifice his son, Isaac, to God. But, at the last minute, God stops the sacrifice and provides a ram

for the sacrifice instead (this is a complicated story, and Becky would be happy to talk with you more about it, but interpretation of the story is not the point of this article). You may also remember that Abraham has two sons. Isaac, the son of his wife Sarah, and Ishmael, the son of their slave, Hagar. In Jewish and Christian traditions, Isaac is considered the heir of Abraham. But in Islamic tradition, the story goes the other way. Hagar is the wife of Abraham, and Ishmael is the rightful heir of Abraham. In

their tradition, the story of Genesis 22 is about how Ishmael is saved by God. The celebration of this non-sacrifice is called Eid al-Adha. The story goes that the ram provided by God is sacrificed by Abraham instead of Ishmael, and then the ram is divided in thirds. One third to Abraham's family, one third to their friends and neighbors, and one third to the poor and needy. In Islamic traditions, Eid al-Adha is a big gift-giving celebration, and focus is made on giving gifts to friends and neighbors as well as the poor and needy. This year, Eid al-Adha begins at sundown on August 31.

We would like to give a gift to our partnership family, the Dauds. Abdirahman has one year of college under his belt, and would like to continue his studies in prison. He and his family have researched schools and the rules of his prison, and he can continue to take courses via correspondence with Ohio University. The cost of this is about \$1,000 per class. He is ready to register, but needs the tuition money before he can register. He would like to take at least one class, but could take up to three. If you are willing to contribute to Ab-

dirahman's tuition costs, you may make a donation Minnehaha and indicate that it is for the Partnership Fund. We will get the money to Ohio University.

In addition, the Daud family is in need of a second car. When Abdirahman was arrested, the FBI impounded his car. It has not been returned to the family, and there is no indication when it might (if ever) be returned. They are making do with one car, but like most of our families, there are a lot of people trying to get to a lot of different places all at the same time. If you have a car you were done using or were thinking of donating and are willing to give it to the Dauds instead, talk to Paul or Beth Minehart about the logistics of that.

And, as always, hold the Daud family in your prayers as they face their own health concerns, negotiate holding down multiple jobs, raise their children, and sort through the prison system. We will have more information about the Daud family members as well as how we can support Abdirahman while he is in prison in the next newsletter.

Eid at a glance

In Islamic traditions, Eid al-Adha is a big gift-giving celebration, and focus is made on giving gifts to friends and neighbors as well as the poor and needy. This year, Eid al-Adha begins at sundown on August 31

TRIVIA ANSWERS (FROM PG. 9)

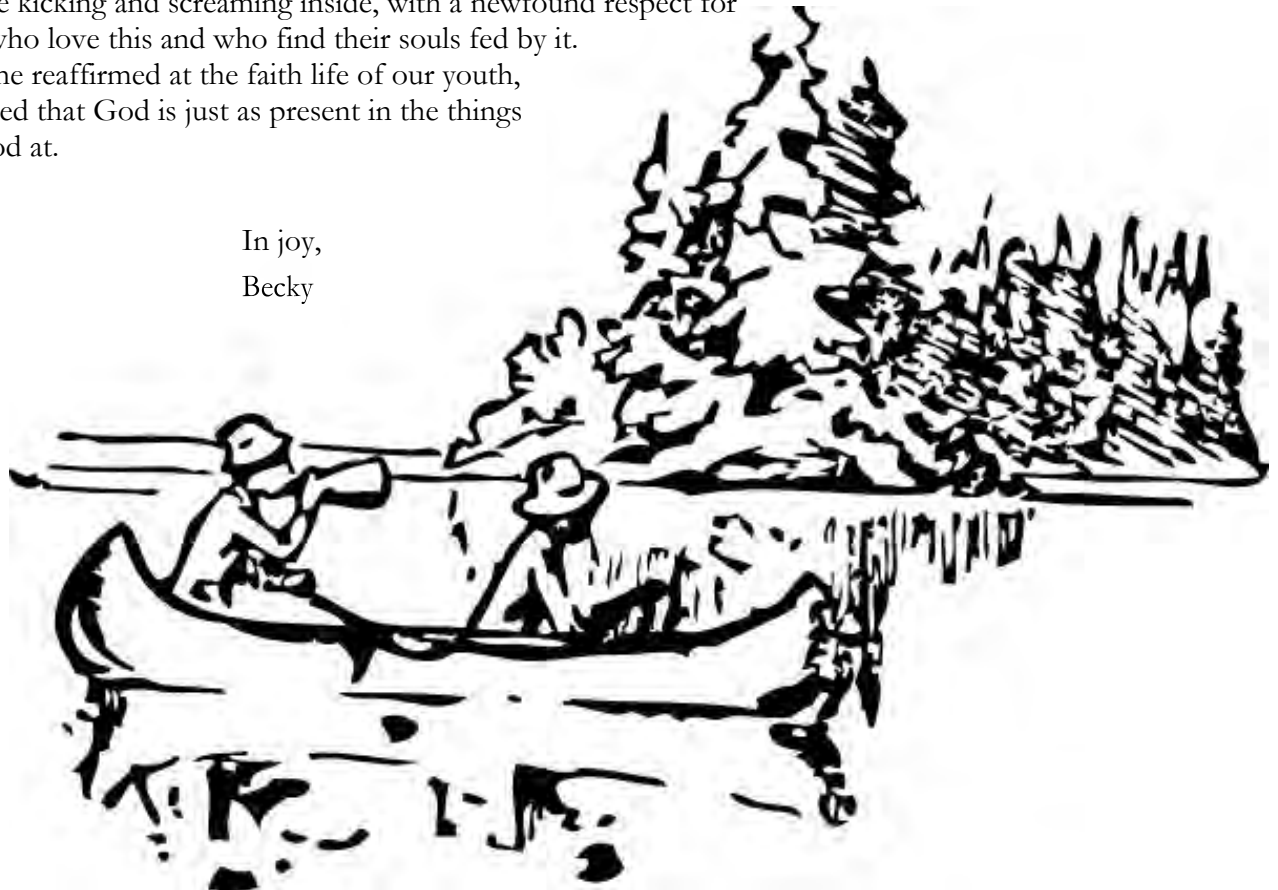
1.) Goat - The goat is an earth sign. 2.) Kenny Rogers' hit song "The Gambler" was released in 1978. 3.) A roman Emperor - The month of August was named after one of Julius Caesar's relatives, Augustus. 4.) Gladiola - The Gladiola represents strength of character and sincerity. 5.) Perdott - The Perdott is a light green stone. 6.) Dary Crockett - Crockett is often called the King of the Wild Frontier. 7.) Leo - Leo starts in July and ends in August. 8.) Toasted marshmallows - On the 30th, you should eat marshmallows but on the 3rd, you should eat watermelon.



Summer Camp

As I write this, I am between summer youth camps. As you read this, I will, thankfully, be done with summer youth camps. I have to admit, youth camp is not my favorite thing. It's not that I don't enjoy the youth. In fact, being with them is what makes me go to youth camp every year. It's that I'm not good at them. I like being outdoors, I like the canoeing and the hiking, but I'm really not all that good at leading the youth in the context of camp. I like teaching confirmation, but I'm actually pretty bad at remaining flexible in the context of camp, and I most definitely do not excel at most of the games we play. So, if I got to choose, I'd probably not attend youth camps. Which would be a shame, because every time I come home from youth camp, I am full of stories about how funny, smart, silly, and amazing our youth are. I get to watch them as they interact with each other, showering each other with grace and forgiveness. I get to watch them struggle to make good, and sometimes hard, decisions. I hear them as they scream and yell just for the fun of it. I get to hear them break into song, break into laughter, and make ridiculous jokes. They poke fun at each other and at the adults. They say the silliest things and the wisest things. They try new foods, and they sneak extra desserts. They form teams that are boys against girls, turn on each other, form new alliances, and then all dissolve into a pile of giggles in the middle of the field. It's amazing to be part of it. And, exhausting. I come home every year, having dragged myself there kicking and screaming inside, with a newfound respect for the adults who love this and who find their souls fed by it. I come home reaffirmed at the faith life of our youth, and reminded that God is just as present in the things I'm not good at.

In joy,
Becky





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8/17



**Look
inside!**



Worship
at the Falls

August 6

Animal
Blessing

Aug. 28



**BACKPACK
Blessing**

August 20